

An 'Open' Platform that Leverages the Power of Collective Wisdom

Here is a methodology that gives a well-defined structure to the process of IP creation and innovation, apart from providing developers with a range of opportunities for continuous learning.

"You cannot solve problems by thinking within the same framework or mindset that discovered the problems."—Albert Einstein

Over the years, open source development has become a very powerful philosophy and engineering paradigm. At its very core, it represents access to the source code for everyone in the developer and user community. This underlying philosophy has helped encourage concurrent development, peer reviews and collaboration, contributing to the success of a lot of open source projects.

But what if the same model was applied by an organisation for software development? Couldn't it also help nurture collaboration and innovation? It is this thought that prompted Collabera Labs, the innovation group of Collabera, to create an internal open source platform. Based on the core characteristics of the open source movement, this model is aimed at making the entire lifecycle of innovation 'open'. This means that right from ideation to implementation, every single step in the process of software development is

performed collaboratively, and with complete transparency and contributions from anyone in the organisation who has the skill-set to contribute to the project.

At a technical level, the source code behind every single asset—whether it is a simple code snippet or a complicated component—is made available to the developers, and they are free to modify it further for their specific needs, says Bala Variyam, V P and head of Collabera Labs. "By participating in these 'open' projects, it is quite possible that someone working on a Java maintenance project is able to participate and learn something quite different, say, cloud computing using Amazon EC2. Regardless of what employees may be currently doing in the organisation, this model gives them an opportunity to participate (and also learn, in the process) in new and cutting-edge technology development."

Looking at Collabera's own example, far beyond the